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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The **1906 San Francisco Earthquake** was a catastrophic event that struck **San Francisco** on April 18, 1906, with an estimated magnitude of 7.8. The quake, caused by a rupture along the **San Andreas Fault**, instantly destroyed large parts of the city. What made the disaster particularly devastating was the massive fires that broke out afterward, fueled by ruptured gas lines and wooden buildings, which burned for several days. An estimated 3,000 people died, and over 80% of the city was damaged or destroyed.

Several factors from the earthquake shaped San Francisco's current landscape:

1. **Urban Reconstruction** – The city was rapidly rebuilt with stricter building codes and wider streets, influencing the layout of downtown San Francisco.
2. **Seismic Awareness** – Modern engineering practices, earthquake-resistant buildings, and infrastructure improvements originated as a response to the 1906 destruction.
3. **Neighborhood Transformation** – Entire districts, like the Marina and parts of the Financial District, were rebuilt or reshaped, changing the urban character and demographics.
4. **Cultural Memory** – The disaster became a key part of San Francisco's identity, influencing local planning, historical preservation, and public safety initiatives.
5. **Geological Visibility** – The earthquake exposed the dynamic fault lines and shifted the ground in ways still detectable today, affecting street patterns, waterfronts, and some building foundations.

Essentially, the 1906 quake not only reshaped the physical city but also influenced its regulatory, cultural, and urban development trajectory, making San Francisco a global example of earthquake resilience.

If you want, I can also make a **map-style summary showing which areas were destroyed and rebuilt**, which clearly shows how the earthquake shaped the cityscape.

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